

Σάτυρος ὁ Ὀξυρυγχίτης

Satyrus of Oxyrhynchus on Alcibiades and Euripides

eul_aid: jii

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine \(frg\)](#)

Domain: Βίος [Biography](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Satyrus of Oxyrhynchus was a Hellenistic biographer of the 3rd century BCE, a native of the Egyptian city of Oxyrhynchus within the Ptolemaic kingdom. His life remains obscure beyond this origin and profession, placing him within the culturally dynamic context of early Hellenistic Egypt.

He is known for a biographical work, the *Lives*, surviving only in fragments. The most substantial of these, preserved on Papyrus Oxyrhynchus 1176, contains parts of his biographies of the tragedians Euripides and Sophocles. These fragments demonstrate his method, which integrated anecdotes, quotations from the subjects' own works, and documentary evidence such as official decrees.

Satyrus holds significance as an early figure in the development of literary biography. His extant fragments provide direct insight into Hellenistic biographical techniques, blending documented fact with narrative. His work influenced later biographical tradition, serving as a source for authors like Diogenes Laertius. Furthermore, his papyrus exemplifies the preservation of Greek literary texts in Egypt, aiding modern understanding of Hellenistic scholarship.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τοῦ Ἀλκιβιάδου Βίου · [Fragments on Alcibiades' Life](#) · 33 passages
- Βίος Εὐριπίδου · [Life of Euripides](#) · 62 passages